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What next for the creative city?

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ABSTRACT

Forming the conclusion to the special issue, this paper begins with a critical engagement with a recent robust, informed, nuanced and eloquent claim by two leading scholars in the field that strategies for a cultural economy are central to the notion of the creative city. The paper suggests that seeking to support the 'intrinsic value' of the cultural economy does introduce a crucial aspect to any progressive urban cultural policy – but that this is not sufficient. The paper suggests the idea of the creative city is not no longer available as a progressive urban cultural policy and that a cultural economy approach on its own does not rectify this. The paper suggests that the more recent origins of the creative city discourse were dependent on much older notions of the 'good city' but that these have been progressively reduced to their economic dimensions. The paper concludes by showing how these older discourses went beyond the purely economic in ways the creative city now finds difficult to capture. A new way of talking about the aspirations towards the good city now need to be found.

> The city as a center where, any day in any year, there may be a fresh encounter with a new talent, a keen mind or a gifted specialist – this is essential to the life of a country. To play this role in our lives a city must have a soul – a university, a great art or music school, a cathedral or a great mosque or temple, a great laboratory or scientific center, as well as the libraries and museums and galleries that bring past and present together. A city must be a place where groups of women and men are seeking and developing the highest things they know.
>
> [Margaret Mead 1978]

> Cities, which want to be innovative, to flourish and to offer wealth and employment to its inhabitants, feel that they have to adapt to arenas in which knowledge and creativity can develop. Culture is often added to this arena, not just as a condition to attract the creative knowledge workers, but also as a major economic sector, intricately interwoven with other sectors of the economy.[2]
>
> [Sako Musterd and Wim Ostendorf 2004]

Introduction: A new approach to the creative city

In this concluding chapter we want to draw together some of the threads of the foregoing papers in order to critically reflect on the interconnection between the creative economy, creative spaces and the creative city. As a way into these reflections we start with a recent paper by Pratt and Hutton (2013) on the creative cities agenda in the wake of the financial crisis. We do not intend a critique of that paper or the wider work of its authors *per se*, rather to use it to test the possibilities and the limits of the notion of the creative (or cultural) economy as a foundation of the creative city. Pratt and Hutton's paper is useful because it makes explicit and robust claims for such a foundation;

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[2] Both these quotations come from a recent paper prepared for a UNESCO Creative Cities conference, Beijing 20/23 October 2013 (http://www.unesco.org/new/index.php?id=117713). Margaret Mead's quotation comes from Redbook Magazine, August 1978 and Musterd and Ostendorf "Creative Cultural Knowledge Cities: Perspectives and Planning Strategies," *Built Environment*, 30, No. 3, 2004:189.

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we do not wish to completely dismiss these claims but to suggest that other, possibly older, notions of the creative city need to come into play if they are to have any real transformative potential.

Pratt and Hutton outline five 'dominant accounts' of the creative city.

First, is that associated with the 'global cities' literature. Here creative industries, when they are considered at all, are seen as symbiotic with, and dependent on, advanced producer services and usually in the form of media, new media, design, advertising and so on. They may also be associated with cultural consumption facilities associated with agglomerations of creative service providers.

Second, is the 'cultural-historic city' with its 'roots in the cities of the Italian quattrocento' and representing 'the highest expression of the synergy between art, design and urban development' (90). This proto-creative city has direct descendants in the 'city beautiful' movements of the 19th century and

> 'in the idealist policies of (elite) state led cultural promotion in the early 20th century in Europe and the US, and their colonies. This is the city of museums and grand architecture that seeks to represent the power and legitimacy of the state and protector of cultural values (90).

This, they suggest, articulated with the national cultural policies of the era, in particular the 'traditional cultural policy that seeks to defend from the dislocations of the market a particular local definition of high culture' (91). The main effect of this 'outside of the narrow confines of the humanist informed argument of culture as a civilising factor for all society' (91) is heritage, and this in turn has fed into the growing cultural and 'creative' tourist economies of the last decades. This cultural heritage approach has also taken off most recently in Asian cities, themselves representing long-standing accumulations of power, prestige and cultural institutions.

Third is 'culture as a hook for foreign direct investment'. This has been in the form of building cultural infrastructure – currently 'iconic' art galleries – that will attract investment by 'mobile capital' and as an attempt to make the city more amenable to employees who might be relocated there. This has also been the area where Richard Florida has been most dominant. Here it is

> 'the relationship, between niche cultural consumption and lifestyle which attracts a particular segment of the labour force (the creative class) to cities, and in turn, as this group is in demand by emergent high-tech companies, they will 'chase' the workers and locate in 'creative cities' (91).

Fourth is culture as social regeneration. This

> 'overlaps a little with a humanistic cultural improvement notion; but in this case the betterment is not so much through high culture as through participation in cultural activities, commonly defined as 'ordinary culture' (91).

This emphasises community projects and intercultural communication, though it also includes sport and culture projects as used by the UK's DCMS for example. Here 'culture is a means to a better city, not an end in itself' (91).

Fifth – and the main focus of the paper – 'culture as industrial policy', is an approach with an 'intrinsic focus on the cultural and creative industries' (91). That is, in 'treating the cultural sector as a primarily economic sector' it acknowledges the 'intrinsic' value they represent rather than, for example, as a stimulant to the refurbishment of old industrial buildings (as in many urban regeneration initiatives).

The authors clearly give normative endorsement to 'culture as industrial policy' and the word 'intrinsic' underscores this. As both authors will be aware, 'intrinsic' has been set against 'instrumental' value in recent debates about the purpose of culture in contemporary public policy. 'Intrinsic' has been a kind of 'art for art's sake' in the face of the extrinsic, instrumentalist measurement of economic and social 'impact'. Pratt and Hutton seem to be reversing these traditional polarities. Large-scale cultural infrastructure investment and programs of cultural consumption and display are 'instrumental' in that they are aiming to attract visitors, mobile talent, inward investment and so on – or indeed, seek 'to represent the power and legitimacy of the state' (91). On the other hand, an industrial, primarily economic program focuses on the intrinsic values and needs of the sector itself.

The normative work of 'intrinsic' is, then, a call to focus on the specificity of the cultural and creative industries (CCI) – or as these authors prefer to call it, the 'creative economy' – as a policy end in itself. 'Intrinsic' gathers additional normative weight from the contrast between *consumption/display* – backed by large-scale state spending – and *production*, which underpins the real resilience and dynamism of the city post-GFC. The creative economy is a good thing for the city because it is directly productive. As the paper makes clear, the creative economy is not simply parasitic on the consumption effects of the financial sector or state funding; it is not 'good time candy floss' (93) but generates wealth and employment in its own right. In many respects the creative economy is the only viable version of the creative city, one based on a 'real' productive sector not just an inducement for other sectors or high-minded cultural policy ideals.

Nevertheless, the authors refuse alignment with that discourse of the creative economy that positions it as part of an inevitable 'post-industrial' economic future. They are suspicious of the creative economy being lumped into the wider narrative of an all-triumphant knowledge economy, with creativity in the driving seat. This narrative has suited politicians trying to position the creative economy more centrally on the policy stage; indeed this was precisely the use made by the UK New Labour government when it launched 'creative industries' as a neologism in 1998 (Garnham, 2005; Tremblay, 2011). The creative economy is not a sub-set of the knowledge economy but a relatively autonomous field.

The authors' reticence to endorse the celebratory narrative of the post-industrial knowledge economy could be interpreted as realism or 'expectation management', an antidote to the over-blown claims of many creative industry proselytisers. In this sense it could also be seen as part of the caveats against over-simplification made in their conclusion.

> [A] one-size-fits-all policy, or explanation, will not work. The uncritical acceptance on the part of a distressingly large number of city authorities of some of the more universalist policy prescriptions of the creative class thesis is likely to produce (to say the least) very uneven results. The 'fast policy' tendency (Peck, 2002) and widespread mimicry of (so-called) 'best practice' lessons generated by the most successful cities should be replaced by 'patient policy' and commitment which recognises, inter alia, the lead time and experimentation required to build successful cultural [sic] economies, and the locally-contingent factors that militate against the utility of generic policy 'templates' (93).

But there is more at work here than slow policy. As the slippage from creative to cultural economies in the quote above suggests, this industry policy is aimed at a sector whose salient characteristic is its production of cultural values, albeit ones outside the traditional frame of public cultural policy. The creative/cultural economy gains its normative charge in this account then, not only through its unique economic contribution but also because a policy engagement with its specific requirements is inevitably a cultural, as well as economic, policy. If taken seriously – rather than being used in a 'fast policy' way to deliver instrumental, superficial gains – the intrinsic economic value of the creative economy is at the same time about its intrinsic cultural value.

Their paper is a call 'to examine a new role for the creative economy in the city… [one] differentiated by governance norms, scale and location' (93). The 'industry policy' called for here is not 'industry policy as usual' simply re-applied to an emerging sector. The way in which the creative economy is defined, and the far-reaching nature of the governance reforms that the sector calls for, necessarily involves a long-term, systemic rethinking of the processes and structures of governance in the creative city itself. Thus to reduce the creative economy to a sub-sector of the service sector 'may be missing a bigger question of the conception of production as a whole' (88), and they reference authors concerned to fundamentally reframe our conceptions of both economy and city life, such as Gibson-Graham (2006) and Amin and Thrift (2004). At stake then is the creative economy as a guide to the new creative city, one that combines cultural and industrial policy in a new way.

Creative economy, hybridity and governance

In this paper it is hard to determine what such far-reaching reforms of governance might entail; Andy Pratt elucidates these in other papers on the creative economy. In support of this particular approach to creative economy policy Pratt first identifies the challenge that the complex and fast-changing nature of the creative economy presents to traditional industry models. Their organisational ecology is distinct, with a 'missing middle' – a few multinationals are surrounded by myriad small and micro-businesses, with a 'shifting network of intermediaries to link the large and the small' (Pratt, 2012: 322). They are organised around projects and networks rather than the individual firm. There is a 'diversity of organisational forms and markets' (322). Finally, there is the

> 'complex overflowing of activities between the formal and the informal, the for-profit and the not-for profit, the state and commercial activities, and between production and consumption. Mutual cross-subsidy takes place not just in time, but also over career lengths of time. In fact, it could be argued that the complex web of interdependencies is one of the core characteristics of the CCI'. (322–323).

Second, this has consequences for policy. 'Solely market based incentives are unlikely to be successful; nor are exclusively public and cultural incentives; a hybrid is required' (323). Equally, the firm cannot be the main locus of policy; rather it needs to be the shifting in-between networks within which they operate. Finally, the high levels of failure in this sector make it risky for public sector bodies to directly support projects. To act successfully here they would need to become 'players' themselves. 'For this, the entry costs for the public sector are very high and are closely associated with highly specific knowledge, trust and experience" (323). The private sector is also incapable of governing, resorting, 'to naïve and crude exercises of corporate power to resolve complex problems as in the case of downloading' (323).

So we have a difficult situation where the object of policy is not stable, nor does it fit into the neat silos of public policy. Industry policy cannot deal with its exceptionalism; it is too 'one size fits all', failing to negotiate the generic/specific divide; failing to deal with the embedded, the specific, the fluid and temporary. On the other hand, as we have seen, hybridity overflows the boundaries of the strictly cultural sphere, whose 'inclination is to treat cultural policy as solely public and not-for-profit activities which support a particular form of high culture'. In addition cultural policy is a 'lightening rod' for too many incompatible objective whilst

> 'little attention is paid to the development of the CCI for their own right: By this we do not mean 'art for art's sake' or the idea that there is some independent 'pure' aim of the CCI, rather the space for a non-instrumental approach, let alone a critical non-instrumental approach that is not dominated by market needs.' (323)

We here return to the ambiguities of the creative cities paper. On the surface we have technical arguments based on the specifics of the policy object, one that is economically valuable (Pratt and Hutton constantly emphasise its growth potential) and demands a new kind of governance. But just below the technical policy surface is a call for a new vision of the creative economy, and the policy settings required to implement it, that are pretty radical. The 'critical non-instrumental approach' – especially one 'not dominated by market needs' – has been a traditional mark of the cultural over against the economic sphere (Sayer). Yet Pratt and Hutton are not talking about 'traditional cultural policy that seeks to defend from the dislocations of the market a particular local definition of high culture' (91). What then is this non-instrumental, hybrid public–private, market/non-market policy space?

It is a space of governance not policy; it is concerned with fields not objects, and engages with processes not outputs. It is, as Pratt says, about the 'art and craft of governance' (325). It works at the interstices of social action, intervening in soft infrastructure and recognising the embedded nature of economic activity. And it works with a range of formal and informal actors and institutions, slowly building up 'intelligent agencies' with accumulated knowledge of, and trust by, the local field. The knowledge is not that of expert systems but relational, contingent:

> 'Various forms of governance have their particular strengths and weaknesses; moreover, they cannot be detached from their context. Moreover, there are no ideal or fixed forms of innovation and creativity; they are all temporary fixes situated in space and time…
>
> These new forms of situated governance
>
> 'would have a revised 'constituency': one that is open to internal organisational dynamics, production processes, regulatory forms and economic development agendas; within such a mode of thinking there is a further possibility of extending such a 'franchise' to social and cultural policy, too. Of course, there is no pre-ordained structural location for such agencies. They could be a third sector, civil society, industry or state body. Openness would be a characteristic". 327

Governance and economic imaginaries

We would not fundamentally disagree with such a new approach to the governance of local cultural economies. An embedded, open, networked, relational approach to governance is certainly crucial to any progressive notion of a creative city. In its hybridization of public/private, subsidized/commercial, culture/industry binaries it embodies a flexible openness to the evolving dynamics of contemporary society and state formation. But it does not explain why such new forms of governance have failed to appear. Certainly the challenges of the creative economy are new and do not fit existing 'policy silos', and so "its 'difference' may render it problematic at best or a failure before it begins" (325). And certainly there are issues with political opportunism, fast policy transfers, one-size-fits-all approaches, the blanket imposition of market mechanisms and so on. But, we would argue, this stems from more than a failure to listen to the technical policy experts.

In seeking the leverage provided by the economic weight of the creative economy to call for a new form of creative city governance the authors fail to register the narrative, or 'imaginary', within which the creative city idea gained its policy traction in the first place. Of course the hybrid culture-economy approach goes back to the years of the Greater London Council; as indeed do early ideas of the creative city, with both Landry (2000), Landry (2006) and Bianchini (Landry & Bianchini, 1995) involved. But it has been the annexation of these ideas by the wider narrative of the knowledge and innovation agenda, via the ubiquitous use of 'creative', that has been crucial in their global fast policy transfer. In short, it has been the economic payoff from culture and creativity that has dominated.

The notion of economic imaginary as developed by Jessop (2004), Jessop (2005) positions it as a way to 'identify, privilege, and seek to stabilize some economic activities from the totality of economic relations and transform them into objects of observation, calculation and governance' (Jessop, 2005: 145). They gain traction as they give coherent and convincing accounts of a particular economic direction and the means to achieve this. For Jessop the "knowledge based economy" has become one such economic imaginary:

> "an increasingly dominant and hegemonic discourse that can frame broader struggles over political, intellectual and moral leadership on various scales as well as over more concrete fields of technical and economic reform"
>
> [Jessop, 2004: 168]

Despite Pratt and Hutton's attempt to distinguish the 'creative' from the 'knowledge' economy and give it a (relatively) autonomous socio-economic space, we would argue that it has been the link to the knowledge economy that has been crucial, a link made particularly resonant in the imaginary of the 'creative city'.

Jessop and Oosterlynck supplement 'imaginary' with the notion of semiosis, as the active production of meaning;

> "what role does semiosis play in construing, constructing, and temporarily stabilizing capitalist social formations at least within specific spatio-temporal fixes and their zones of relative stability even as it displaces and defers conflicts, contradictions, and crisis- tendencies elsewhere and/or into the future?"
>
> [Jessop & Oosterlynck, 2008: 1156]

If we replace semiosis with 'creative city' it becomes clear that the term is not (just) a superficial policy fad adopted by lazy politicians but is actually performing something in and on the city. To confront this imaginary with its policy inadequacies, the disjunction between the rhetoric and the reality, as do Pratt and Hutton, is useful but it is not enough. For the creative city imaginary organises institutions and actors, from state, civil society and the commercial sector, in ways that allow them to 'fail forwards' (Peck, 2010), recouping immediate benefits whilst displacing the conflicts and contradictions to some future date. Meanwhile the citizens deal with the consequences of those failures.

O'Connor and Gu (2010) have described how an embedded, networked 'intelligent agency' emerged out of an open, networked encounter between creative economy intermediaries and local government in Manchester. Performing in many ways like those agencies outlined by Pratt (cf. also Pratt & Jeffcutt, 2009) it worked within a shared imaginary of the economic and cultural contribution of the creative sector to Manchester and its attempts to re-invent itself as a post-industrial city. However, it was precipitously closed down when the local economic development agencies decided to invest in Salford's *Mediacity* – a top-down agglomeration of re-located BBC departments, some small commercial media companies, and a local university all wrapped up in a real estate deal. This echoes the wider under-investment in creative industry agencies in the UK and Australia – two countries singled out by Pratt as having moved beyond old-style high culture policy settings. We can add Germany (Bader & Scharenberg, 2010) and Ireland (McCarthy, 2002; Strachan & Leonard, 2000) in their reliance on urban development as the means to creative cities. Despite the rhetoric of the creative city-economy by national and city governments in all these countries, funding for creative industry agencies is miniscule to non-existent – even compared to the already small arts and culture budgets.

Again, in this issue Xin Gu, Shan Shilian, Lie Liu and Justin O'Connor have variously explored the situation in Shanghai, Shenzhen and China more generally. Here a very powerful, centre-directed policy rhetoric of creative city-economy has been launched. One theme running through all of these accounts is a disconnect between the creative city-economy imaginary and the 'intrinsic' needs and aspirations of those involved in the arts, creative clusters, creative businesses and the production of urban cultural space–time. The disjunction between rhetoric and reality will lead to revised policy settings, but not necessarily to the benefit of the creative sector.

Similarly, this issue as a whole has highlighted the central importance of urban space to the creative city-economy. Hutton (2008) have each separately discussed the crucial contribution of flexible urban spaces for agglomeration economies. O'Connor and Gu generally, and Shaw in the case of Melbourne, have above described creative space as one of the key contradictions of the creative city – both in the 'real' and the 'imaginary'. Spaces for creative production are being squeezed in inverse proportion to the growing rhetoric of the creative city. The complex, circuitous ways in which redundant urban spaces were brought back into creative use in the last decades of the 20th century have now been short-circuited into a direct, undisguised use of artists and creatives by developers to enhance property values by offering short-term leases. City governments have found it impossible to assert the value of access to cheap creative space on a flexible basis in the face of the inexorable logic of the 'free' market in land. If it challenged such a logic in the past, on the grounds of public health (parks), education (universities, libraries, museums), civic pride (monuments, cultural facilities, vistas and the 'city beautiful') and so on, it is clear that the creative city-economy has failed to provide a similar contemporary rationale. It is handmaiden not handbrake for urban real estate development.

The cultural sector has long used the imaginary of the cultural and then creative economy as a way to secure greater funding. At the cusp of the transformation from cultural to creative in 1998 it seemed that a win for culture was a win for the economy. A new concordat seemed to be established between the oppositional or hedonistic culture of the 1960s (Bell, 1976) and the capitalism it had depended on but disavowed. The cultural contradictions of capitalism were now re-written as the harbinger of its renewal. It seems to us that this benign narrative, the imaginary of a creative city-economy is no longer an option – at least not in this form. Pratt and Hutton's call for a focus on the intrinsic needs of a creative sector as a way of opening up an alternative economic and cultural policy, and indeed carving out a non-instrumental, non-market space, is useful but ultimately it is caught in an imaginary it cannot control. Like the infamous, and infinitely lesser creative class narrative, the creative city-economy recruits the cultural sector into a coalition in which it is a very junior partner.

Even on its own terms however the creative city-economy was a partial vision of the city. Pratt and Hutton's separation of consumption-led and production-led approaches, intended to highlight the specific and autonomous economic contribution of the creative economy and its intrinsic development needs, ignored how consumption and production have always been interlinked. This is not just in terms of the creative ecology of the city – where the formal and informal spaces and institutions of the city provide the context for exchange and learning – but in the less welcome connection between cultural consumption and production and small privileged enclaves. This link was present in discourses around the yuppies in the 1980s, the Bo-Bos in the 1990s and the more recent 'hipsters' – all of which is complexly wrapped up in notions of gentrification. There are connections between creative economy and city in which creatives are not simply dupes.

This is not to lump all artists and creatives in the same basket. It is clear that persistent low-pay, long-hours, insecurity, un- and underemployment and self-exploitation are key characteristics of the creative sector labour. It is also clear that many artists and creative have become fervent critics of the creative city (see for example Nion, 2010) just as they have engaged in local initiatives that have contributed culturally, socially and economically to local communities. The point we would make is that the grounds for supporting the creative city-economy may need to be derived from outside its intrinsic needs; we would suggest they lie in broader ideas of what the good city and urban citizenship might be.

The good city

The two quotes at the top come from a position paper released for a 2013 UNESCO *Creative Cities* summit in Beijing. They describe an arc in which an older, broader vision of what a city culture might be is reduced to a factor in inter-city competitiveness. We would argue that an alternative imaginary of the 'good city' is required. Whilst Pratt and Hutton's version of the non-instrumental governance space of the creative economy would be crucial to this it cannot found such an alternative imaginary and indeed would be dependent on it to achieve its full expression. Such an imaginary might look to some of the creative city models summarily dismissed by Pratt and Hutton at the beginning of their article.

Models one and three – advanced producer services and Floridian 'foreign direct investment' – we have suggested are more intrinsic to the creative city-economy imaginary than Pratt and Hutton are willing to acknowledge. We are left with the 'cultural-historic city' – reduced to high-culture and heritage – and 'culture as social regeneration' – where 'culture is a means to a better city, not an end in itself' (91). Dismissing these as 'instrumental-extrinsic' and as consumption/display rather than production in fact works to undermine the possibility of a non-instrumental, non-market policy space.

Tracing the lineage of traditional 'high culture' policies, intervening against the market, through the 19th century 'City beautiful' back to the Italian quattrocento indicates that more is at stake here than the purely aesthetic. If the Italian city-states represented 'the highest expression of the synergy between art, design and urban development' (90) this suggests a conception of a civic whole and the position of the citizen within this. It was an assertion of a bounded community whose collective welfare and duties were of paramount importance. In recalling these city-states the 19th century it was not just the 'city beautiful' movements but the wider revival of 'civic pride' and urbanity that attempted to retrieve a collective values over and above those of unrestrained capitalism. This certainly involved projecting the 'power and legitimacy of the state'; but the state was often local and it was often held to be more democratically accessible than that of the distant nation-state.

This concern with the city did not end with the 19th century but continued in the work of planners and urban theorists into the 20th century. Mumford (1961) and Jacobs (1969), to name but two, tried to re-think the horizons of urban citizenship and the ideal of the good city in the era of the industrial city. Indeed, these histories of the 20th century city are being retrieved after their trashing by both neo-liberalism and urban postmodernism (Hatherley, 2010; Meek, 2014; Shaw & Montana, in press).

The early versions of the 'creative city' – to be found in the work of Charles Landry and Franco Bianchini, alongside a number of pan-European and pan-Anglophone networks – began as an attempt to retrieve an urbanity and sense of civic and local community believed to have been lost by the Fordist-Modernist planning regimes of the post-war city. However ersatz and clichéd the café and piazza – synecdoches of a retrieved urbanity – became they began as attempts to reclaim the city for its citizens. In this sense it linked to that community arts movement which did see culture as a means to a better, more inclusive city. Moreover (Shaw, O'Connor and Gu) this movement not only began to open up redundant city spaces for cultural use but also began to test the limits of traditional arts policy – including the early versions of the 'cultural economy' thesis.

The point we would wish to make is that these older versions of the cultural and creative city involved a re-imagining of the urban collective – the values embodied by it and viable limits it set to the purely capitalist conception of the city. This is not to call for a return to an outmoded 'civic pride' and its associated monuments, nor for a resolutely subsidy-led 'high art' program. It is that only by recognising a 'community' as a value over and above the maximisation of profit that limits can be set to the unfettered power of market and capital. This, for example, is the starting point of Gibson-Graham's (2006) post-capitalism economics, for Amin, Massey, and Thrift (2000) work on 'cities for the many not for the few', as it was Karl Polanyi's (1944) defence of social democracy.

One part of the creative city began as an attempt to add new cultural forms to the grammar of an older urbanity; another part suggesting these new cultural forms could provide the economic driver of this new city, whilst at the same time taming the excesses of an Fordist, utilitarian capitalism. That these new forms of culture and of urbanity could co-exist with increasing social polarisation; with massive financial and political disinvestment from 'non-creative' cities and neighbourhoods; with ever-higher levels of capitalisation of urban space; and with the systematic undermining of the collective horizons of the city itself: this was unexpected.

The challenge of the good city and urban citizenship is before us. It includes if/how an urban collective can be sustained in a global and mobile world (Cunnigham, 2011); the infrastructure – soft and hard – required for this; the grammar and the virtues (in the Aristotelian sense) required of the citizens; a new rationale for the 'trusteeship' of the city and its memories; and the new forms of open, embedded governance required. But the immediate challenge to find a new imaginary for the city-collective, one that is not just the city-economy, and certainly not the combination of finance and real estate to which this economy has been further reduced. The creative city no longer has any traction in this task.

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